

grant women the right to vote. However, things deteriorated after the “Liberating Revolution” of 1955 to 1958 that ended the second presidential term of Perón. References to his charismatic late wife Eva, the founder of the Female Peronist Party and champion of women’s suffrage, were strictly forbidden.

Argentina’s new anti-Peronist government imprisoned hundreds of women it viewed as threats to the regime. State violence increased and culminated in the “Dirty War” of 1976 to 1983 in which government agents kidnapped, tortured, and killed dissidents. Mothers of the so-called “disappeared” established the Mothers of the Plaza de Mayo group to pressure the military government to reveal what had happened to their children. The high-profile campaign led to the discovery of many of the missing children—both alive and dead.

In Bolivia, many women fought in the 19th century for independence from colonial Spain, yet they only earned the right to

vote in 1952 after the Bolivian Social Revolution. In 1978 miner’s wife and unionist Domitila Barriou de Chúngrara led a hunger strike that brought down the dictatorship of General Hugo Bánzer Suárez, leading to the return of democracy.

Fighting for independence

Women took part in Mexico’s revolution from 1910 to 1920, particularly indigenous women known as *soldaderas*, who were combatants. Notable among these was Petra Herrera who joined Pancho Villa’s army. When her role in taking Torreón went unacknowledged, she left and formed an all-female troop of soldiers. Despite finally gaining the right to vote in national elections in 1953, Mexican women, like many in Latin America, still face discrimination due to a culture of machismo.

▼ Strong mothers

Members of the Mothers of the Plaza de Mayo group protest in front of the presidential palace in Buenos Aires during 1982 to find out what happened to their sons and daughters.

